

Welcome to Christ Presbyterian Church of New Haven!

We are delighted that you have chosen to join us in worship this Lord's Day.
It is our sincere hope and prayer that you will know the saving presence, power, love and authority of our King and Savior Jesus Christ as a result of our time spent together in worship.

We would also like to get more acquainted with you, so please take the time to **fill out the register** as it comes down your row during the announcements. Please use the prayer card located in the inside pocket of the register or the back of pews to communicate your prayer requests or other concerns and place it in the basket on the back table as you leave the worship service. Your requests are prayed for during the week.

As a church, we value family worship, and therefore children of all ages are welcome to join us in the worship service at their parents' discretion. However, **childcare** is available (off of the foyer area - Children's Education Wing) for parents who wish to take advantage of it (there is no age restriction). Please do not hesitate to ask a greeter for assistance.

Introduction and Welcome to CPC - please pick up your free copy on the table located at the foyer entrance.

Our Offices are adjacent to the sanctuary. Core office hours at CPC are from 8:30 am to 2:30 pm Monday-Thursday. Should you need to use our facilities, please call our Administrator to make arrangements. We are currently building a unique library and reading room containing various selections of books, journals, children's literature and tapes (library is located in our balcony area). Selections may be checked out or you are welcome to drop by for a reading break from your busy schedule.

Parking - On Sundays, please reserve the on-site parking lot for our visitors & parents with small children. In courtesy to our neighbors, please do not park in front of Bradley St. homes, but use the RIS parking lot located next door. **During the week**, please contact our administrator for parking information as most of our spaces are rented out during the week. And, for safety reasons, exit the lot on the Bradley Street side only. Thank you.

Log onto: *christpresnewhaven.org* for more information or calendar events.
You may also call 777-6960 and press 5 to hear weekly events.

Sermon MP3's are downloadable online or are available upon request for \$3 per CD. To order a copy, please fill out a request sheet (located in the foyer) and place your payment into the container labeled Media Payments.

As a church committed to Greater New Haven, we meet in the middle of the region we hope to serve and reach, which consists of both downtown New Haven and the surrounding edge towns. We believe that the gospel transcends all ethnic, social, and demographic boundaries. We are ambitious for the glory of God and aim to extend a Christ-centered gospel throughout Greater New Haven.

We reuse bulletin covers - if you do not need one - please place covers on the foyer table as you leave.

September 30, 2007

10:30 AM

THE WORSHIP OF GOD

Service Order 4

Prelude & Pre-Worship Meditation

The resurrection and sitting in heaven, which are here mentioned, are not yet seen by mortal eyes. Yet, as if those blessings were presently in our possession, he states that we have received them; and illustrates the change which has taken place in our condition, when we were led from Adam to Christ. It is as if we had been brought from the deepest hell to heaven itself. And certainly, although, as respects ourselves, our salvation is still the object of hope, yet in Christ we already possess a blessed immortality and glory; and therefore, he adds, in Christ Jesus. Hitherto it does not appear in the members, but only in the head; yet, in consequence of the secret union, it belongs truly to the members.

John Calvin, On Ephesians 2:6

The flesh of Christ is life-giving, not only because once in it our salvation was obtained; but because now we being united to him in sacred union, it breathes life into us... because being by the power of the Spirit engrafted into the body of Christ, we have a common life with him; for from the hidden fountain of divinity life is, in a wonderful way, infused into the flesh of Christ and thence flows out to us... Christ is absent from us as to the body; by his Spirit, however dwelling in us, he so lifts us to himself in heaven, that he transfuses the life-giving vigor of his flesh into us, as we grow by vital heat of the sun.

John Calvin, Institutes...

Our justification... rests on the objective merit of Christ, by whose blood alone propitiation has been made for the sins of the world. But this justification, to become ours in fact, must insert us into Christ's life... We must have Christ himself formed in us more and more in a real way in order that he may be made unto us of God, wisdom and righteousness and sanctification, and redemption... Christ's life... rests not in his separate person, but passes over to his people; thus constituting the Church, which is his body, the fullness of Him that filleth all in all.

John Nevin, "The Mystical Presence of Christ"

Liturgical Definitions:

Prelude & Pre-Worship Meditation:

A time to quiet your heart and mind in preparation to enter into the life-giving presence of God.

"Be still, and know that I am God! I am exalted among the nations, I am exalted in the earth." Psalms 46:10

Invitational Songs of Prayers for God's Presence

And I looked, and there in heaven a door stood open. Revelation 4:1

* Congregation Standing wherever indicated throughout bulletin.

Note: Trinity Hymnal can be found in pews for hymns indicated with numbers

**O Day of Rest and Gladness*

*O Day of rest and gladness, O Day of joy and light
O Balm of care and sadness, Most beautiful, most bright;
On Thee the high and lowly, Through ages joined in tune,
Sing Holy, Holy, Holy, To the great God Triune.*

*On Thee, at the creation, The light first had Its birth;
On Thee, for our salvation, Christ rose from depths of earth;
On Thee our Lord, victorious, The Spirit sent from heav’n
And thus on Thee, most glorious, A triple light was giv’n.*

*Thou art a port protected, From storms that round us rise;
A garden intersected, With streams of Paradise;
Thou art a cooling fountain, In life’s dry, dreary sand;
From Thee, like Pisgah’s mountain, We view our promised Land.*

*Today on weary nations, The heav’nly manna falls:
To holy convocations, The silver trumpet calls,
Where gospel light is glowing, With pure and radiant beams
And living water flowing, With soul refreshing streams.*

*New graces ever gaining, From this our day of rest,
We reach the rest remaining, To spirits of the blest.
To Holy Ghost be praises, To Father, and to Son;
The church her voice upraises, To thee, blest Three in One.*

Call to Worship
*And the first voice, which I had
heard speaking to me like a
trumpet, said, “Come up here,
and I will show you what must
take place after this.” At once I
was in the spirit, and there in
heaven stood a throne, with one
seated on the throne! Rev. 4:2*

**Hymn of Praise: O For A Thousand Tongues to Sing*

*O for a thousand tongues to sing
My great Redeemer’s praise,
The glories of my God and King,
The triumphs of His grace.*

*My gracious Master and my God,
Assist me to proclaim,
To spread through all the earth abroad
The honors of Thy name.*

*Jesus, the name that charms our fears,
That bids our sorrows cease;
‘Tis music in the sinner’s ears,
‘Tis life and health and peace.*

*He breaks the pow’r of reigning sin,
He sets the pris’ner free;
His blood can make the foulest clean,
His blood availed for me.*

*He speaks and, list’ning to His voice,
New life the dead receive;
The mournful, broken hearts rejoice;
The humble poor believe.*

*Hear Him, ye deaf; His praise, ye dumb,
Your loosen’d tongues employ;
Ye blind, behold your Savior come;
And leap, ye lame, for joy.*

WORSHIP THROUGH INVOCATION AND ADORATION

*Call to Worship: Revelation 7:9-12

Leader: After this I looked and there before me was a great multitude that no one could count, from every nation, tribe, people and language, standing before the throne and in front of the lamb. They were wearing white robes and were holding palm branches in their hands. And they cried out in a loud voice:

People: “*Salvation belongs to our God, who sits on the throne, and to the Lamb.*”

Leader: All the angels were standing around the throne and around the elders and the four living creatures. They fell down on their faces before the throne and worshiped God, saying:

People: “*Amen! Praise and glory and wisdom and thanks and honor and power and strength be to our God for ever and ever. Amen!*”

*Invocation and Prayer of Adoration

*Doxology (#733)

*Praise God from whom all blessings flow;
Praise Him all creatures here below, Alleluia, Alleluia!
Praise Him above ye heavenly host;
Praise Father, Son and Holy Ghost;
O Praise Him! O Praise Him! Alleluia, Alleluia, Alleluia!*

Old Testament Reading: Genesis 28:10-17
New Testament Reading: Ephesians 1:7-10, 20-23, 2:4-7, 3:14-21
Reader: This is the Word of the Lord!
People: *Thanks be to God!*

Invocation and Praise
Day and night without
ceasing they sing,
“Holy, holy, holy, is the Lord
God the Almighty, who was and
is and is to come.”
Rev. 4:8

Hearing God’s Word
A time to hear God’s holy
Word, ultimately unveiled to
us in Christ by the Holy
Spirit.

*Then I saw in the right hand of
the one seated on the throne a
scroll written on the inside and
on the back, sealed with seven
seals. Rev. 5:1*

Meditation: *Bless the Lord*
[A good time for children to leave for childcare - if so desired.]

*Bless the Lord my soul, and bless God’s holy name.
Bless the Lord my soul, who leads me into life.*

Sing 2x

WORSHIP THROUGH CONFESSION AND ABSOLUTION

Corporate Confession:
[Participants may kneel or lean forward]

Leader: Let us confess our sins to God our Father.

People: *Most holy and merciful Father, we acknowledge and confess before You our sinful nature prone to evil and resistant in doing good, and all our shortcomings and offenses. You alone know how often we have sinned: in wandering from Your ways, in wasting Your gifts, in forgetting Your love, in acting as the unfaithful wife, in playing the harlot after false gods, we have been unfaithful to you. O Lord, have mercy upon us, who are ashamed and sorry for everything in which we have displeased You. Teach us to hate our errors, cleanse us from our secret faults, and forgive our sins, for the sake of your dear Son. And O most holy and loving Father, help us, we beseech You, to live in Your light and walk in Your ways, according to the commandments of Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.*
[Based upon The Book of Common Worship, first order]

Private Confession

Meditation on God’s Word
In stillness and meditation,
please take a moment to
reflect on the power and
privilege of hearing God’s
Word.

Confession of Sin
Because sin is so pervasive in
both our corporate and
individual lives, we are
invited to come before God
with honesty and
transparency, confessing our
brokenness and moral
failures, asking for both
forgiveness and healing
through Jesus Christ. We
confess corporately to show
our unity even in our
brokenness. We confess
honestly because in Christ,
we are safe to confess our
sins without fear of
condemnation and no longer
in need of hiding in
defensiveness and blame
shifting.

*And I saw a mighty angel
proclaiming with a loud voice,
“Who is worthy to open the
scroll and break its seals?” And
no one in heaven or on earth or
under the earth was able to open
the scroll or to look into it. And
I began to weep bitterly because
no one was found worthy to
open the scroll or to look into it.
Rev. 2:4*

Absolution

Leader: Hear now God’s assurance of pardon:

“The saying is sure and worthy of full acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners-- of whom I am the foremost.”

1Timothy 1:15

Pastoral Prayer

[Participants may be seated]

Prayer for our Members: Tim and Molly Gribble
Special Needs: Grad/College Student Partnership; Lillian Cozza
Mission to the World: Kenya: Jennifer Courtney; Karl & Debbie Dorzbach and Family; Karen Hill; Tim & Marti Hutchison and Family; Scott & Mary Ann Nelson and Family; and Lois Ooms

Absolution

Christ has given the Church authority to declare the forgiveness of sins in his Name. This promise is for all who have been joined to Christ by faith as mediated through any gospel-believing church.

“I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven, and whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.” (Mt. 16:19)

Pastoral Prayers

Our prayers are ultimately “in the name of Jesus Christ,” which means that our trust is not in the power of our prayers, but in the power of Christ’s prayers who prays for us as our “great high priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus, the Son of God... For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who in every respect has been tested as we are, yet without sin. Let us therefore approach the throne of grace with boldness, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need.
Heb. 4:14-16

The four living creatures and the twenty-four elders fell before the Lamb, each holding a harp and golden bowls full of incense, which are the prayers of the saints. Rev. 5:8

*Song of Response: *Arise, My Soul Arise*

*Arise, my soul, arise shake off your guilty fears;
The bleeding sacrifice on my behalf appears
Before the throne my surety stands,
Before the throne my surety stands
My name is written on his hands*

*Arise, arise, arise, arise my soul arise
Arise, arise, arise, arise my soul arise
Shake off your guilty fears and rise.*

*He ever lives above for me to intercede,
His all redeeming love His precious blood to plead
His blood atoned for every race
His blood atoned for every race
And sprinkles now the throne of grace.*

Chorus

*Five bleeding wounds he bears, received on Calvary
They pour effectual prayers they strongly plead for me
Forgive him, O forgive they cry
Forgive him, O forgive they cry,
Don’t let that ransomed sinner die!*

Chorus

*My God is reconciled His pardning voice I hear;
He owns me for His child I can no longer fear;
With confidence I now draw nigh
With confidence I now draw nigh
And “Father, Abba, Father!” cry.*

Chorus

WORSHIP THROUGH THE WORD

Sermon: In Him in the Heavenly Places and the Sacramental
Way of Life: Expositions in Christian Spirituality
Rev. Preston Graham

[Sermon notes located on page 16]

Chapter 1:7 In him we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of his grace, 8which he lavished upon us, in all wisdom and insight 9 making known to us the mystery of his will, according to his purpose, which he set forth in Christ 10as a plan for the fullness of time, to unite all things in him, things in heaven and things on earth. ... 20 that he worked in Christ when he raised him from the dead and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly places, 21 far above all rule and authority and power and dominion, and above every name that is named, not only in this age but also in the one to come. 22And he put all things under his feet and gave him as head over all things to the church, 23 which is his body, the fullness of him who fills all in all.

Chapter 2:4 But God, being rich in mercy, because of the great love with which he loved us, 5even when we were dead in our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ— by grace you have been saved— 6and raised us up with him and seated us with him in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus, 7so that in the coming ages he might show the immeasurable riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Christ Jesus.

Chapter 3:14 For this reason I bow my knees before the Father, 15from whom every family in heaven and on earth is named, 16that according to the riches of his glory he may grant you to be strengthened with power through his Spirit in your inner being, 17 so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith—that you, being rooted and grounded in love, 18may have strength to comprehend with all the saints what is the breadth and length and height and depth, 19and to know the love of Christ that surpasses knowledge, that you may be filled with all the fullness of God. ... 20 Now to him who is able to do far more abundantly than all that we ask or think, according to the power at work within us, 21 to him be glory in the church and in Christ Jesus throughout all generations, forever and ever. Amen.

Ephesians 1:7-10, 20-23, 2:4-7, 3:14-21

Sermon

A sermon is not just teaching for living a moral life; it is mainly a time when the living Christ Himself encounters His people through His Word bringing to us the full truth and grace of the gospel. Therefore, as you listen, pray to encounter the life-changing Christ.

Then I saw in the right hand of the one seated on the throne a scroll written on the inside and on the back, sealed with seven seals, They sing a new song: “You are worthy to take the scroll and to open its seals, for you were slaughtered and by your blood you ransomed for God saints from every tribe and language and people and nation; you have made them to be a kingdom and priests serving our God, and they will reign on earth.”
Rev. 5:1, 9-10

Right after the sermon is a good time to retrieve your children from childcare to experience the Lord’s Table, especially on the weeks we come forward (first Sunday of the month) in order to receive God’s blessing for his covenant children.

People were bringing even infants to him that he might touch them; and when the disciples saw it, they sternly ordered them not to do it. But Jesus called for them and said, “Let the little children come to me, and do not stop them; for it is to such as these that the kingdom of God belongs.
Luke 18:15-16

WORSHIP THROUGH SACRAMENT

Introduction to the Lord’s Table

The Collection of the Communion of the Saints
“For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich, yet for your sake he became poor, so that you by his poverty might become rich.”
2 Corinthians 8:9

Collection Hymn: **Amazing Grace** (vs. 1, 2, 4 & 6) #460

**Amazing grace! How sweet the sound
That saved a wretch like me!
I once was lost, but now am found,
Was blind, but now I see.**

**‘Twas grace that taught my heart to fear,
And grace my fears relieved;
How precious did that grace appear
The hour I first believed!**

**The Lord has promised good to me,
His Word my hope secures;
He will my shield and portion be,
As long as life endures**

**When we’ve been here ten thousand years,
Bright shining as the sun,
We’ve no less days to sing God’s praise
Than when we’ve first begun.**

Communion Gifts

We give not as a payment for a service rendered nor out of compulsion to gain God’s favor. The communion offering is symbolic of offering our whole lives and weekly vocations in consecration to God in spiritual service of worship! It is as if we join the holy procession of saints throughout history in offering ourselves as a living and holy sacrifice made acceptable to God by Christ who completes us by faith. Please give as an act of worship and only if you can give cheerfully as unto the Lord.

The twenty-four elders fall before the one who is seated on the throne and worship the one who lives forever and ever; they cast their crowns before the throne, singing, “You are worthy, our Lord and God, to receive glory and honor and power, for you created all things, and by your will they existed and were created.”
Rev. 4:10-11

*Presentation of Gifts

[Please stand as we present our lives and gifts to Christ at His banquet table.]

...and they cast their crowns before the throne, singing, “You are worthy, our Lord and God, to receive glory and honor and power, for You created all things, and by Your will they existed and were created.”

Revelation 4:10-11

*Processional Hymn: *All People That on Earth Do Dwell (vs.1) #1*

*All people that on earth do dwell,
Sing to the Lord with cheerful voice;
Him serve with fear, His praise forth-tell,
Come ye before Him and rejoice.*

*Confession of Faith

Leader: Christians, what do you believe?

People: In all my distress and persecution, I turn my eyes to the heavens and confidently await as judge the very One who has already stood trial in my place before God and so has removed the whole curse from me. All His enemies and mine, He will condemn to everlasting punishment--but me and all His chosen ones, He will take along with Him into the joy and the glory of heaven. I believe that God, because of Christ's atonement, will never hold against me any of my sins nor my sinful nature, which I need to struggle against all my life. Rather in His grace God grants me the righteousness of Christ to free me forever from judgment.

[Heidelberg Catechism, question 52 & 56]

**The Eucharistic Sacrament
of the Lord’s Supper:**

Eucharist means “the good grace” and “communion” implies a real participation in that grace. Therefore, the

Lord’s Supper is both a thankful memorial service to remember Christ’s sacrificial death on the cross and a life giving participation in that grace as we are being united to Christ in heaven by the Holy Spirit and received by faith. In short, Christ is really present in, with and through the sacrament of the Lord’s Supper, even if not bodily but spiritually as being united to the body of Christ in the church.

Then I looked, and I heard the voice of many angels surrounding the throne and the living creatures and the elders; they numbered myriads of myriads and thousands of thousands, singing with full voice, “Worthy is the Lamb that was slaughtered to receive power and wealth and wisdom and might and honor and glory and blessing!” Rev. 5:11-12

*Prayer of Thanksgiving

Pastor: Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.

People: It is right to give Him thanks and praise.

Pastor: Therefore we praise you, joining our voices with Angels and Archangels and with all the company of heaven, who forever sing this hymn to proclaim the glory of your Name:

*All: Holy, Holy, Holy Lord, God of power and might,
Heaven and earth are full of your glory.
Hosanna in the highest.
Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord.
Hosanna in the highest.*

Prayer of Consecration

Invitation to the Lord’s Table

Words of Institution

Pastor: Therefore we proclaim the mystery of faith:

*All: Christ has died.
Christ is risen.
Christ will come again.*

Pastor: Alleluia! Christ our Passover is sacrificed for us;

All: Therefore let us keep the feast. Alleluia!

Pastor: The Gifts of God for the People of God.
Take them in remembrance that Christ died for you,
and feed on him in your hearts by faith, with
thanksgiving.

Sharing the Bread and Cup

Note concerning the elements of the Lord's Supper
We serve wine in the Lord's Supper, believing it to be the biblical element used. We provide grape juice for those who, out of conscience or reasons of health, do not partake of wine. Grape juice is in the outer rim.

Prayers for those not communing:

~Prayer for those searching

Oh God, I am discovering that the more I have, the more I need to have, the more I am loved, the more I need to be loved, the more I achieve, the more I need to achieve. Nothing seems to satisfy me. "Nothing tastes." Could it be, as someone once said, that "Our hearts are restless until they find their rest in thee." Dear God, if this is true, and if as the Bible teaches there is life and life eternal in Christ alone, please guide me to Him. Open me to the reality of the One who alone can satisfy my restless heart. Give me the courage to believe that which I cannot see but can understand, feel and touch through the Word, sacraments and church family. Lord I want to believe, please help me in my unbelief! Amen.

~Prayer of belief

Lord God, I now see that I am weaker and more flawed than I ever before believed, but in Christ, I am more loved and accepted than I ever dared hope. Even as I have not loved You or my neighbor with all of my heart, You have shown Your love for me in that while I am still sinning, Christ died for me and took upon Himself the condemnation that I deserve. I now know that You owe me nothing for my efforts, but You offer acceptance, love and blessing into all eternity because of Christ's efforts on my behalf. I therefore ask that You would enable me to turn away from trusting in my own efforts to gain Your acceptance and forgiveness, and trust in the perfectly righteous efforts of Christ on my behalf in order to be accepted by You and entered into Your holy family. And just as You raised Christ from the dead, so too I ask that You would give me a new life in Christ, one that will lead eventually to Heaven itself. Thank you for Christ, and the power of the Holy Spirit to believe in Him alone for my salvation. And as You have called us to follow You in baptism and in a life of committed discipleship in Your church, grant that I may take the necessary steps to be one with Your people, and live in the fullness of Your Spirit. Amen.

Prayers for those not communing
Those who have genuinely confessed their own brokenness in sin, received Christ by faith and have joined to Christ by means of joining any gospel believing church are invited to partake of the Lord's Supper. If you are not yet prepared to participate in the sacrament, please know that we are glad that you are here, even as we respect your sincerity for not participating at this time. We want CPC to be a safe place for you to be "in journey" and would not want you to feel any compulsion to partake until it is the right time as noted above. With you in mind, we have included some prayers if you would desire some aid in praying to God during this time.

*Closing Hymn:

The Head That Once Was Crowned With Thorns

#298

*The Head that once was crowned with thorns
Is crowned with glory now;
A royal diadem adorns
The mighty Victor's brow.*

*The highest place that heaven affords
Is His, is His by right,
The King of kings and Lord of lords,
And heaven's eternal Light;*

*The Joy of all who dwell above,
The Joy of all below
To whom He manifests His love
And grants His name to know.*

*To them the cross, with all its shame,
With all its grace, is given;
Their name an everlasting name,
Their joy the joy of heaven.*

*They suffer with their Lord below,
They reign with Him above,
Their profit and their joy to know
The mystery of His love.*

*The cross He bore is life and health,
Though shame and death to Him:
His people's hope, His people's wealth,
Their everlasting theme.*

Hymns of Coronation and Praise

“Then I heard every creature in heaven and on earth and under the earth and in the sea, and all that is in them, singing, “To the one seated on the throne and to the Lamb be blessing and honor and glory and might forever and ever!” And the four living creatures said, “Amen!” And the elders fell down and worshiped.” Rev. 5:13-14

Prayer of Thanksgiving

*Gloria Patri (#735)

*Glory be to the Father, and to the Son and to the Holy Ghost;
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be,
World without end. Amen, Amen!*

*Benediction

Leader: And after you have suffered for awhile, may the God of all grace, who called you to his eternal glory in Christ, himself restore, support, strengthen, and establish you. For to Him be the power forever and ever. Amen.

1 Peter 5:10-11

People: Thanks be to God! Hallelujah!

Postlude

Sermon Notes

In Him in the Heavenly Places and the Sacramental Way of Life:
Expositions in Christian Spirituality

Exposition:

Main Point:

Inferences:

[Music reprinted by permission – CCL #745254]

